

Nurturing Bharat's adolescents for the future

Summer vacations are here again, bringing excitement and **anticipation** for children and parents **alike**. Recently, Prime Minister Narendra Modi, during his 120th **episode** of Mann Ki Baat aired on 30 March 2025, **passionately** encouraged schools, families, and communities to use these months meaningfully. With hashtags like #MyHolidays and #HolidayMemories, PM Modi beautifully **highlighted** that vacations could be more than just **leisure**; they could nurture **holistic** growth in young minds. In this context, it's essential to **reflect on** how the National Education Policy (NEP) 2020 and institutions like the Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT) are shaping the future of Bharat, particularly focusing on adolescents. The NEP 2020 is celebrated worldwide for its **visionary stance** on education that **bridges** traditional cultural wisdom with modern **interdisciplinary** practices.

It recognises adolescence as a **vital** stage of personal and emotional growth — a truth **vividly** captured in Netflix's recent series Adolescence, where **teenagers struggle** to find their identity amid cultural and emotional **complexities**. **Anthropologist** Margaret Mead once **remarked**, "The young, free to act on their initiative, can lead their elders in the direction of the unknown," **aptly** summarising the potential and **restlessness** of youth.

Here, CCRT **steps in** effectively, translating the vision of NEP 2020 and National Curriculum Framework (NCF) 2023 into reality. CCRT has been actively promoting arts and cultural education by **blending** age-old wisdom with **contemporary** teaching methods. UNESCO's **Framework** for Culture and Arts Education **highlights precisely** this — cultural literacy is not just beneficial but essential for **sustainable** and **cohesive** societies.

Globally, successful educational **models**, such as those in Finland, South Korea and Japan, **underscore** the importance of cultural education. **Finland**, **often** praised for its education system, **integrates** cultural **appreciation** deeply within its **curriculum**. Similarly, South Korea has earned global **recognition** for **infusing** its educational framework with a rich cultural heritage.

Bharat, long celebrated as a Vishwaguru, now **has** the opportunity to **reclaim** its leadership by implementing cultural education initiatives guided by policies like NEP 2020. CCRT's **initiatives** (under the Ministry of Culture, Government of India) — which include the Digital District Repository (DDR) Project and specialised teacher-training workshops in art-based **pedagogy** — **have profoundly** influenced adolescents, especially at the grassroots level.

These initiatives **foster** a genuine sense of cultural pride and self-awareness, helping young people **navigate** identity struggles similar to those **depicted** realistically in Adolescence. With the summer holidays upon us, the timing couldn't be better. PM Modi's appeal **resonates** with CCRT's vision of turning leisure time into learning adventures.

Imagine our children **swapping mundane** afternoons of screen time for **immersive** storytelling sessions, theatre workshops, or hands-on experiences in traditional crafts. Certainly, these experiences promise far richer holiday stories to share with hashtags #MyHolidays and #HolidayMemories!

Furthermore, cultural and heritage education nurtures **empathy** — an **indispensable** quality in our rapidly globalising world. It also offers emotional **resilience**, equipping adolescents with the confidence to **address** modern-day challenges. So, as summer camps begin and **cheerful** voices **echo** through activity-filled sessions, let us recognise the perfect **harmony** between NEP 2020's vision and CCRT's mission. Together, they foster culturally conscious, globally minded citizens deeply rooted in Bharatiya traditions. **Indeed, Bharat**, as the original Vishwaguru, **is** well-positioned to **lead by example** in educational innovation. Cultural education is not **merely** about **preserving** traditions — it is about empowering the next generation.

Let's **wholeheartedly embrace** this idea, transforming this summer vacation into an unforgettable journey of cultural discovery and growth for Bharat's adolescents.

[Practice Exercise]

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'.

Vocabulary

1. **Nurture** (verb) – cultivate, foster, support, develop, nourish विकसित करना
2. **Adolescent** (noun) – teenager, youth, juvenile, minor, youngster किशोर
3. **Anticipation** (noun) – expectation, excitement, eagerness, hope, suspense प्रत्याशा
4. **Alike** (preposition) – equally, similarly, both, in the same way, likewise समान रूप से
5. **Episode** (noun) – segment, part, installment, broadcast, occurrence कड़ी / प्रसंग
6. **Passionately** (adverb) – fervently, intensely, enthusiastically, zealously, emotionally उत्साहपूर्वक
7. **Highlight** (verb) – emphasize, underline, showcase, bring out, stress जोर देना
8. **Leisure** (noun) – free time, relaxation, break, recreation, downtime अवकाश
9. **Holistic** (adjective) – complete, comprehensive, integrated, all-encompassing, overall समग्र
10. **Reflect** (on) (verb) – think about, consider, ponder, contemplate, review विचार करना
11. **Visionary** (adjective) – forward-thinking, imaginative, idealistic, insightful, pioneering दूरदर्शी
12. **Stance** (noun) – position, viewpoint, perspective, approach, opinion रुख
13. **Bridge** (verb) – connect, link, unify, span, reconcile जोड़ना
14. **Interdisciplinary** (adjective) – cross-disciplinary, integrated, mixed-subject, collaborative, multifaceted अंतर्विषयक
15. **Vital** (adjective) – crucial, essential, important, key, fundamental आवश्यक
16. **Vividly** (adverb) – clearly, strikingly, intensely, distinctly, expressively स्पष्ट रूप से
17. **Complexity** (noun) – intricacy, difficulty, complication, sophistication, challenge जटिलता
18. **Anthropologist** (noun) – social scientist, human researcher, ethnologist, cultural analyst, human studies expert मानवशास्त्री
19. **Remark** (verb) – comment, state, observe, say, note टिप्पणी करना
20. **Aptly** (adverb) – suitably, appropriately, fittingly, rightly, accurately उपयुक्त रूप से
21. **Restlessness** (noun) – unease, impatience, agitation, anxiety, disquiet बेचैनी

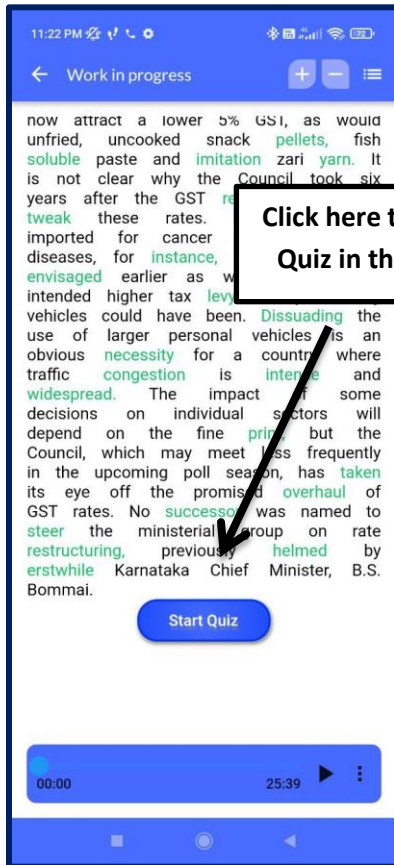
22. **Step in** (phrasal verb) – intervene, act, involve, take action, participate हस्तक्षेप करना / भाग लेना
23. **Blend** (verb) – combine, mix, merge, integrate, fuse मिलाना
24. **Contemporary** (adjective) – modern, current, up-to-date, present-day, recent आधुनिक
25. **Precisely** (adverb) – exactly, accurately, definitely, clearly, specifically सटीक रूप से
26. **Sustainable** (adjective) – enduring, long-lasting, eco-friendly, maintainable, viable टिकाऊ
27. **Cohesive** (adjective) – united, connected, consistent, integrated, bonded एकजुट
28. **Underscore** (verb) – emphasize, highlight, stress, affirm, mark ज़ोर देना
29. **Often** (adverb) – frequently, regularly, repeatedly, many times, commonly अक्सर
30. **Integrate** (verb) – incorporate, merge, blend, unite, combine समाहित करना
31. **Appreciation** (noun) – admiration, recognition, understanding, value, respect सराहना
32. **Curriculum** (noun) – syllabus, program, course content, academic plan, study framework पाठ्यक्रम
33. **Recognition** (noun) – acknowledgment, appreciation, respect, acclaim, acceptance मान्यता
34. **Infuse** (verb) – instill, inject, introduce, implant, incorporate समाहित करना / भरना
35. **Reclaim** (verb) – regain, retrieve, restore, recover, take back पुनः प्राप्त करना
36. **Pedagogy** (noun) – teaching method, educational approach, instructional technique, learning practice, academic method शिक्षाशास्त्र
37. **Profoundly** (adverb) – deeply, significantly, meaningfully, intensely, thoroughly गहराई से
38. **Foster** (verb) – nurture, encourage, support, promote, cultivate बढ़ावा देना
39. **Navigate** (verb) – manage, handle, deal with, steer through, work through रास्ता निकालना
40. **Depict** (verb) – portray, show, illustrate, represent, describe चित्रित करना
41. **Resonate** (verb) – echo, align with, strike a chord, connect, reflect गूँजना
42. **Swap** (verb) – exchange, trade, switch, substitute, alternate बदलना
43. **Mundane** (adjective) – boring, routine, dull, unexciting, ordinary सामान्य

44. **Immersive storytelling** (noun) – It involves the use of technology tools like VR to immerse the audience in a 360-degree narrative
45. **Empathy** (noun) – understanding, compassion, sensitivity, kindness, emotional insight सहानुभूति
46. **Indispensable** (adjective) – essential, crucial, necessary, vital, mandatory अनिवार्य
47. **Resilience** (noun) – strength, toughness, adaptability, recovery, perseverance दृढ़ता
48. **Address** (verb) – deal with, confront, respond to, resolve, tackle हल करना
49. **Cheerful** (adjective) – joyful, happy, bright, lively, upbeat प्रसन्नचित
50. **Echo** (verb) – reflect, repeat, resonate, reverberate, resound गूँजना
51. **Harmony** (noun) – peace, balance, unity, agreement, coordination तालमेल
52. **Indeed** (adverb) – certainly, truly, surely, in fact, really वास्तव में
53. **Lead by example** (phrase) – set an example, show the way, inspire through action, guide, be a role model उदाहरण प्रस्तुत करना
54. **Merely** (adverb) – only, simply, just, solely, nothing more than मात्र
55. **Preserve** (verb) – protect, maintain, save, conserve, safeguard संरक्षित करना
56. **Wholeheartedly** (adverb) – sincerely, fully, earnestly, genuinely, enthusiastically पूरे मन से
57. **Embrace** (verb) – accept, adopt, welcome, support, take on अपनाना

Summary of the Editorial

1. **PM Modi's Holiday Message** – In the March 2025 *Mann Ki Baat*, PM Modi encouraged meaningful engagement during summer vacations using hashtags like **#MyHolidays** and **#HolidayMemories**.
2. **More Than Leisure** – Vacations should be used to nurture **holistic development** in adolescents, not just rest and relaxation.
3. **NEP 2020's Vision** – The **National Education Policy (NEP) 2020** promotes a balanced approach that blends traditional cultural wisdom with modern education.
4. **Adolescence as a Crucial Phase** – NEP 2020 acknowledges adolescence as a **critical stage** of emotional, social, and personal development.
5. **Media Reflection** – Netflix's *Adolescence* series reflects the identity struggles and emotional complexity faced by today's teens.
6. **Power of Youth** – Citing Margaret Mead, the editorial stresses the **potential of young minds** to lead change and innovate.
7. **CCRT's Role** – The **Centre for Cultural Resources and Training (CCRT)** plays a key role in implementing NEP and the **National Curriculum Framework 2023**.
8. **Cultural Literacy** – UNESCO and CCRT emphasize **cultural education** as a foundation for **cohesive, sustainable societies**.
9. **Global Examples** – Countries like **Finland, South Korea, and Japan** have successfully embedded cultural education into their systems.
10. **Reclaiming Vishwaguru Status** – Bharat has the opportunity to reclaim its role as a **Vishwaguru** (world teacher) through cultural and value-based education.
11. **Grassroots Impact** – CCRT's grassroots efforts, such as the **Digital District Repository (DDR)** and **art-based teacher training**, impact adolescent identity and pride.
12. **Creative Alternatives to Screen Time** – Vacations can involve storytelling, crafts, and theatre, offering **enriching experiences** over passive screen use.
13. **Building Emotional Resilience** – Cultural education fosters **empathy and emotional strength**, helping youth face global challenges.
14. **NEP & CCRT Synergy** – The alignment of **NEP 2020's educational vision** with **CCRT's cultural mission** creates a robust support system for adolescent development.
15. **Empowering the Next Generation** – Cultural education is not just preservation, but a powerful tool to **empower youth** as confident, rooted, and globally aware citizens.

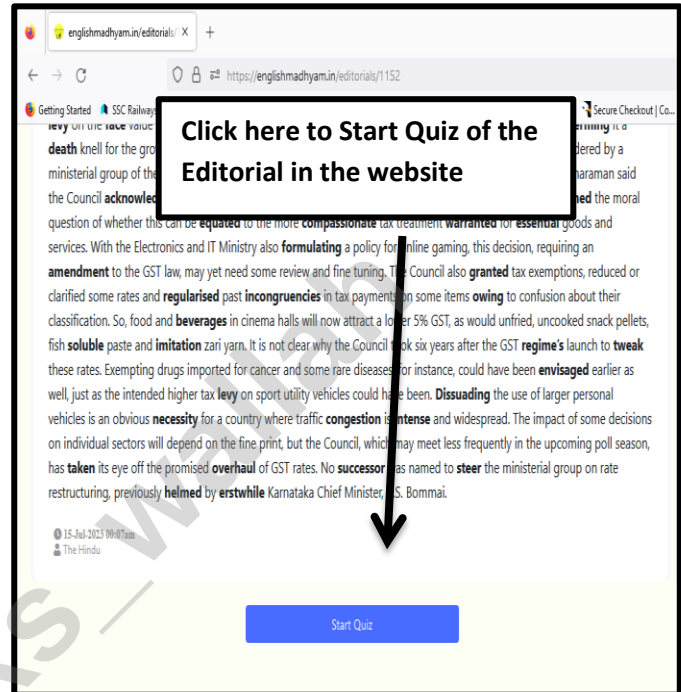
Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



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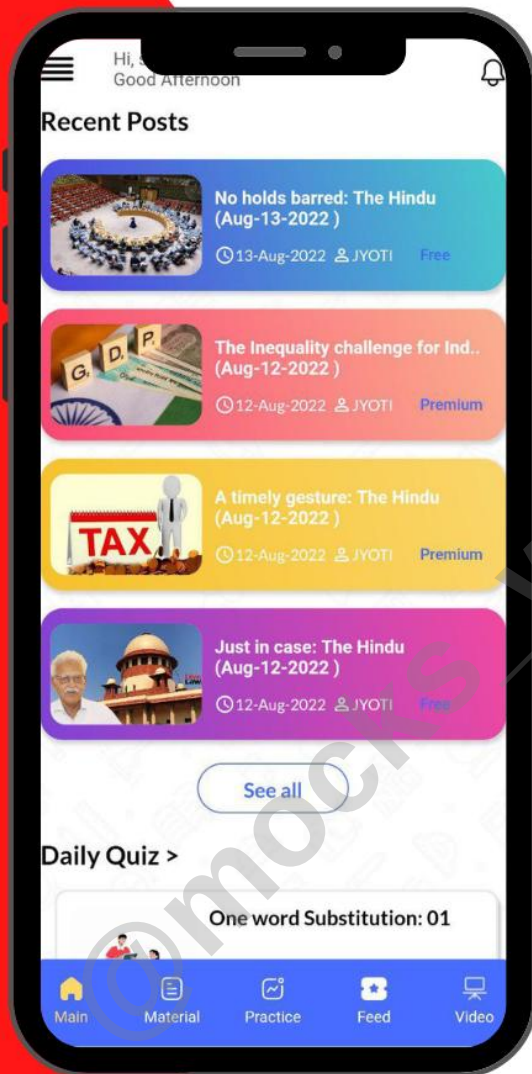
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